

WHY BIOLOGY

Feed the organisms that feed your plants.



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

Plants don't feed alone.

Bacteria and fungi produce enzymes that break down minerals and organic matter and free the nutrients they contain. When protozoa and nematodes consume those bacteria and fungi, the surplus is released right at the root, in plant-available form.

Bacteria produce glues that bind soil particles into microaggregates; fungal hyphae weave those into larger macroaggregates. The result behaves like a sponge, holding water, letting air flow in and resisting erosion.

These microbes are often lost in land that has been chemically managed or compacted. Biologically complete compost is designed to restore them.

OUR STORY

Dr. Elaine Ingham mapped the Soil Food Web and taught the world to restore it. The Soil Food Web Foundation, established in October 2025, carries her work forward with growers on working land.



Her published record, in full, on our site:
soilfoodweb.com/publications



Watch a free webinar

A live hour with an instructor or a practitioner, every month. The easiest first step.

soilfoodweb.com/brochure-webinar

COMMUNITY

Join a global community of Soil Regenerators.



A workshop group around a finished compost pile.

We believe your food is only as nutritious as your soil is alive.

Farmers, consultants, gardeners and people who care where their food comes from are part of this community. It's easy to find your place in this movement. Reach out to discover opportunities to join us as a student, volunteer, ambassador, donor and partner. As a nonprofit, the best way to support us is to share our message and resources with people who need them.



Join the free online community

Meet other people in the regenerative agricultural space. Get your questions answered by other practitioners of the Soil Food Web Approach who share the desire to restore the world's soils.

soilfoodweb.com/brochure-community



STUDY



VOLUNTEER



DONATE



HOST



Soil Food Web Foundation

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit



Grow your own biology.

The soil beneath our farms and forests is alive.

A web of bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods feeds plants, builds soil, stores carbon and cleans water *when it is intact*.

We train farmers, and the people who work with them, to transition from chemical inputs to biology. You'll learn to test your soil, produce your own BioComplete™ compost and liquid amendments, and rebalance the microbial content of your fields. Living soil is the solution, and it is beneath your feet.



EDUCATION



RESEARCH



PRACTICE



COMMUNITY

132+

Countries in our student and practitioner community

10,000+

Individuals enrolled in our programs

45

Years of soil biology research behind the method

**Healing soil.
Feeding humanity.
Restoring the living world.**



Learn more

Curious about the Soil Food Web approach? Visit our website to explore our courses, workshops, and free resources.

soilfoodweb.com

PRACTICE

Growers are implementing this at every scale.



Agroecology plots at Rancho Cacachilas.

Growers like you are cutting inputs and improving soil, and documenting it.

The basic methodology is universal; the application is based upon locally-sourced materials. Whether you tend a rooftop container or a thousand-acre farm, the principle is the same.

Nick Padwick farms in Norfolk, England. Roberto Silva farms in Piura, Peru. Jenn Sirp grows in California.



Find a trained professional near you

Our graduates who complete their certifications to become consultants and lab-technicians are listed in our online directory. Hire an earned title, not a claim.



Watch a case study from your crop or region.

Hear growers explain in their own words how the Soil Food Web Approach changed their operations through reducing inputs, creating better outputs and improving their bottom lines.

sfw.one/brochure-casestudies

Results shown are from individual sites in specific contexts; outcomes vary with climate, crop and management.

ON YOUR FARM

We start with your soil.



Soil samples beside the microscope.

The steps are the same at every scale: look at the biology under a microscope, add what is missing to rebalance the microbial content, then measure again to confirm microbial counts are going in the expected directions.

What we test before we recommend

-  **Diagnostic first.** Every recommendation starts with a biological analysis under a microscope.
-  **Measurable.** We provide a relative count of various microbes present in your soil or compost sample.
-  **Adaptation and retrofitting.** We help you convert your current operations to the Soil Food Web Approach, at any scale.



Testate amoeba, 40x objective. Photograph: Joy Kaluf. A microbial count names what is present in the sample and their relative numbers: bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods.

What healthy soil biology does



CYCLES
NUTRIENTS



CREATES
SOIL
STRUCTURE



INHIBITS
WEED
PRESSURE



REDUCES
PESTS AND
DISEASE

The approach is designed to dramatically reduce dependence on chemical inputs.

LEARN

Learn to grow your own soil biology.



A mentor teaching on working land.

Everyone starts with the Foundation Courses. Where you go next depends on whether you want to apply your skills to your own land or help other farmers improve their soils.

Start learning

The Foundation Courses give you the biological literacy to understand what is actually happening in your soil, why it matters, and what you can do about it. They are online, self-paced, take about 150 hours to complete, and are a prerequisite to any Advanced Program.

Go professional

Learn the practical application of the theory you learned in the Foundation Courses through mentor-led Advanced Programs on Soil Microscopy, BioComplete™ Compost Production, and Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial.

Learn in person

Accelerator Workshops are immersive, two-week, hands-on intensives where you produce BioComplete™ compost and biological liquid amendments live, hosted with a partner on their land. Gain a year's worth of hands-on experience in one immersive workshop.

Where it leads

Careers in soil biology analysis as SFW Lab-Technicians, and working with farmers and land stewards to implement the Soil Food Web Approach as SFW Consultants.



Apply for a scholarship

Cost shouldn't keep anyone from healing soil. Scholarships prioritize applicants in under-resourced regions.

sfw.one/brochure-scholarship